

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

District by Zomato

Plan with Friends: Group Activity Planning for Amusements

Document Version	v1.0 May 2026
Status	Draft
Product POC	Naveen Gupta
Vertical	District Amusements and Activities
Platform	District iOS + Android
Priority	PRD 2 of 2, Activities Vertical

01. The Problem

Here is how every group outing to an amusement park actually starts in India today.

Someone in a college group chat says let us go to Smaaash this weekend. Twenty messages follow. Some people want Saturday, some want Sunday. Half the group has not even seen the message yet. Someone asks how much it costs. Someone else says they checked and tickets are Rs 999 per person. Two people drop out. Three more join. Nobody knows the final headcount.

By Thursday, the plan has collapsed. Nobody confirmed. Nobody booked. The outing never happened.

This is the group planning problem for amusements. It is not about price or availability. It is about coordination chaos that kills plans before they ever reach the booking stage.

District today has no feature that helps a group of friends move from 'let us go somewhere' to 'we have confirmed tickets.' The product was built for solo or couple bookings. Groups, which are the dominant use case for amusement parks, go-kart tracks, and adventure activities, are entirely unserved.

The Real Cost of This Gap

What groups do today	Why	What it costs District
Coordinate entirely on WhatsApp, never reach a booking	No group planning tool exists inside District	Potential group bookings of Rs 4,000 to Rs 15,000 per session never convert
One person books for everyone and chases money later	Simpler than coordinating separately	Lower ticket count per booking, host friction reduces repeat behavior
Book directly from venue website after coordinating offline	No reason to use District specifically for group coordination	District loses the transaction and the relationship with each group member

Why This is Bigger Than a UX Problem

Amusement parks and go-kart tracks have a fundamental unit economics problem: their capacity is fixed but their revenue depends on headcount. A group of 6 friends booking Smaaash on a Saturday generates 6x the ticket revenue of a solo visitor. District capturing that group booking is not just a UX win. It is a GMV multiplier.

Additionally, every new friend who joins a Plan with Friends session and does not have District installed is a forced install moment. The invite link becomes the most efficient acquisition channel in the Activities vertical because the motivation to install is immediate: your friends are already going and you will be left out if you do not join.

02. Objective

Build a group activity planning feature inside District that takes a group of friends from 'let us go somewhere' to 'tickets are booked and costs are split' without anyone having to leave the app or coordinate on WhatsApp.

Goals

1. Convert group intent into group bookings: give friends a shared space inside District to agree on a venue, confirm attendance, and complete a group booking in one flow.
2. Drive new user acquisition: every Plan with Friends invite sent to a non-District user is a high-intent install moment. The person receiving the invite has immediate social motivation to install.
3. Increase average booking value for amusements: a group booking of 5 people at Worlds of Wonder at Rs 1,200 per ticket is a Rs 6,000 transaction vs a Rs 1,200 solo booking. Plan with Friends directly increases per-session GMV.
4. Reduce host friction on group payments: the host pays the full booking amount upfront and the app handles split collection from each friend automatically, removing the most socially awkward part of group outings.

Non-Goals

- Group ordering of food or delivery: this feature is scoped strictly to activity and amusement bookings, not Zomato food ordering.
- Open group plans visible to all District users: plans are private, invite-only sessions. This is not a social discovery feature.
- Venue suggestions or AI recommendations within the session: Phase 1 is coordination around a venue the host has already chosen. Discovery is a Phase 2 addition.
- Real-time chat inside the session: friends coordinate on WhatsApp. The session is a decision and booking tool, not a messaging product.

03. Target Users

Persona	Current Behavior	What They Need
Rohan, 22 Delhi College student planning a go-karting session at Smaaash with 5 friends	Starts a WhatsApp thread, gets 20 replies, loses track of who confirmed, gives up by Friday. The plan dies in the chat.	One link he can share that shows the venue, the date, the price per head, and lets each friend tap 'I am in.' No chasing, no confusion.
Sneha, 27 Bengaluru Working professional organising a team outing to Wonderla	Books tickets herself, pays upfront, spends the next week collecting money from 8 colleagues on UPI. Deeply frustrating every time.	A way to confirm headcount first, then let the app split and collect payment from each person. She wants to be a participant, not an unpaid coordinator.
Vikram, 19 Mumbai Receives a Plan with Friends invite but does not have District installed	Cannot join. Gets excluded from the plan. The group either waits or moves on without him.	A frictionless install-and-join flow: taps the link, installs District, lands directly in the active plan session with his friends already there.

Vikram represents the acquisition opportunity. Every Plan with Friends session that includes a non-District user is a forced, high-intent install moment. The install is not happening because of an ad. It is happening because his friends are already going and he will miss out if he does not join.

04. The Solution

Plan with Friends is a group activity planning and booking feature inside the District Activities vertical. A host picks an amusement park, go-kart track, or activity venue, sets a date, and shares a session link. Friends tap the link, install District if they do not have it, and join the session. Each friend confirms whether they are attending and how many tickets they need. The host sees the full confirmed headcount, completes the booking for the group in one transaction, and the app automatically requests each friend to pay their share back via UPI.

What Makes This Different From Just Sharing a Link

Sharing a WhatsApp link today	Plan with Friends
Link goes to the venue page. Each person has to book separately.	All confirmations happen inside one session. One group booking.
Host has to count replies and guess headcount.	Host sees a live confirmed headcount before paying.
Payment collection happens after the outing over UPI. Awkward.	App sends payment requests to each friend automatically after host pays.
Non-District users are excluded entirely.	Non-District users install the app to join. Acquisition moment.
Plan dies in chat if no one takes ownership.	Session has a confirmation deadline. Creates urgency to decide.

The Complete User Flow

Step 1: Host Creates a Plan

- Host opens the District app and finds the venue they want: Smaaash CP, Worlds of Wonder, a go-kart track, or any activity listing.
- On the venue detail page, a 'Plan with Friends' button appears alongside the regular Book Now button.
- Host taps Plan with Friends. They set: the visit date, the preferred time slot (if applicable), and an optional message to friends (e.g., 'Bhai Saturday karting, Rs 999 per head, confirm by Thursday').
- A unique 6-digit session code and a shareable link are generated instantly. The link opens directly inside the District app on the venue's Plan page. For users without District installed, the link routes to the app store first, then deep-links into the session after install.

Step 2: Friends Join the Session

- Friends receive the link on WhatsApp or any channel. They tap it.
- If District is already installed: they land directly on the Plan session page showing the venue, date, host name, confirmed members so far, and price per person.
- If District is not installed: they see a branded install screen showing the plan details and a single 'Join the Plan' CTA. After install and quick sign-up, they land directly inside the active session. Not the home screen. Not a generic onboarding. The plan.
- Each friend confirms their attendance with one tap: 'I am in' or 'Cannot make it.' Friends who confirm also select their ticket count (e.g., 1 adult, or 1 adult + 1 child).
- The host sees each confirmation in real time. A session timer is visible: the plan expires at the deadline the host set.

Step 3: Host Books for the Group

14. Once the host is satisfied with the confirmed headcount, they tap 'Book for the Group.'
15. The booking summary shows: venue name, visit date, total confirmed attendees broken down by ticket type, and total booking amount.
16. Host reviews and confirms. They pay the full booking amount via UPI, card, or any District-supported payment method.
17. Booking is confirmed for the full group. All confirmed members receive a booking confirmation notification with venue details, date, time, and their individual ticket information.

Step 4: Split Payment Collection

18. After the host pays, the app automatically calculates each confirmed friend's share based on their ticket selection.
19. Each friend receives a UPI payment request inside the District app: 'Rohan paid for the group booking at Smaaash. Your share is Rs 999. Pay Rohan back.'
20. Friends pay directly inside District via UPI. The host sees a live payment tracker showing who has paid and who is pending.
21. Friends who have not paid within 24 hours receive a reminder notification. The host can also send a manual nudge with one tap.
22. Once all payments are collected, the host receives a confirmation and the session is marked complete.

Alternatives Considered

Option	Decision	Reason
Each friend pays their own share directly at checkout (no host pays first)	Rejected for Phase 1	Requires all friends to be online simultaneously at checkout. Group booking confirmation becomes dependent on 5 people's payment timing. Too much friction. Host-pays-first with post-payment collection is simpler and more reliable.
Real-time chat inside the Plan session	Rejected	Adds significant product scope. Friends already have WhatsApp. The session is a decision and booking tool. Adding chat competes with behavior that is already working.
AI-suggested venues based on group preferences	Phase 2	Requires preference data that does not exist for new users. Phase 1 is coordination around a host-chosen venue. Suggestions come after trust and data are established.
Host creates plan, friends book their own tickets separately	Rejected	Does not solve the coordination problem. Separate bookings mean different ticket references, different payment records, and no group experience.

05. How We Measure Success

North Star Metric

Group Bookings Completed per Week: the number of Plan with Friends sessions where a host confirmed attendance, placed the group booking, and at least 2 friends joined and paid their share.

Target: 5,000 completed group bookings per week at 30 days post-launch. Target: 25,000 per week at 90 days.

Supporting Metrics

Metric	Baseline	30 Days	90 Days
Average group size per completed booking	No data	3.5+ people	4.5+ people
Average GMV per Plan with Friends session	No data	Rs 3,500+	Rs 5,500+
New user installs via Plan with Friends invite link	0	10,000+	60,000+
Session invite link click-through rate	0%	Above 55%	Above 65%
Friend confirmation rate (join rate per invite)	0%	Above 45%	Above 55%
Split payment collection rate within 48 hours	0%	Above 70%	Above 85%
Session abandonment rate (plan created but never booked)	0%	Below 40%	Below 25%

Guardrail Metrics: Must Not Get Worse

Guardrail	Alert Threshold
Individual booking flow time-to-complete	Must NOT increase. Plan with Friends is a separate flow and must not slow down solo bookings.
Host payment failure rate	Must NOT exceed 3%. Group bookings involve larger amounts. Payment reliability is critical.
Venue ticket availability conflicts on group bookings	Must NOT exceed 2%. Ticket inventory must be held from the moment the host initiates checkout.
New user install-to-join conversion rate	Must NOT drop below 40%. If the install-then-join flow is too long, acquisition value drops to zero.

06. User Stories

ID	Story
US01	As a host, I want to create a Plan with Friends session for a specific amusement venue and date so that I can coordinate the outing without managing a WhatsApp thread.
US02	As a host, I want to share a session link via WhatsApp so that my friends can join from any device or platform without me adding them manually.
US03	As a friend who receives an invite, I want to see the venue, date, and price per head clearly before confirming my attendance so that I can make an informed decision quickly.
US04	As a friend who does not have District installed, I want to install the app and land directly inside my friends' Plan session so that I do not have to search for the plan after installing.
US05	As a host, I want to see a live count of confirmed attendees before booking so that I know exactly how many tickets to purchase.
US06	As a host, I want the app to automatically send split payment requests to each confirmed friend after I pay so that I do not have to chase people for money individually.
US07	As a confirmed friend, I want to receive a UPI payment request inside District for my share of the booking so that I can pay my host back without switching apps.
US08	As a host, I want all confirmed attendees to receive booking confirmation with ticket details after the group booking is placed so that everyone has their own reference.

07. Key Edge Cases

Scenario	Trigger	System Behavior
Session deadline passes before host books	Host sets a Thursday deadline. Only 2 friends confirm by then.	Session expires. Host is notified with confirmed count and given the option to extend the deadline by 24 hours or proceed with the confirmed group size.
Ticket inventory drops below confirmed group size	Host confirms 8 attendees but only 5 tickets remain at that time slot	Host is notified immediately with available options: switch to a different time slot, reduce group size, or cancel the session. Inventory is not held until host initiates checkout.
Friend declines after host has already paid and booked	Sneha pays for 6 people. One friend says they cannot make it after booking.	The ticket is already booked and non-refundable as per venue policy. The cancellation policy of the venue applies. Friend's share is still owed to the host. The payment request remains active.
Friend does not pay their share within 48 hours	Payment request sent. Friend ignores it.	One automated reminder at 24 hours. Host can send one manual nudge. After 72 hours the host is shown the outstanding amount and advised to settle offline. District does not hold the booking hostage to payment collection.
Session link shared publicly in a large group	Host shares link in a 200-member college WhatsApp group	Session has a maximum of 12 participants. After 12 joins, the link shows 'This plan is full.' Host can set a lower cap at creation.
Non-District user tries to join on a browser without installing	Friend taps the link on a desktop browser	Browser view shows a read-only plan summary: venue, date, confirmed friends, price per head. A clear prompt states: 'Download District to join this plan.' No web-based joining in Phase 1.

08. Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Level	Mitigation
Low session completion rate: friends confirm but host never books	High	Session has a visible deadline with a countdown. 24 hours before expiry, the host gets a push notification: 'Your plan for Smaaash expires tomorrow. 4 friends are confirmed. Book now.' Creates urgency without being intrusive.
Install-to-join drop-off: non-District users install but abandon before joining the session	High	The install deep-link must land the user directly inside the plan with zero friction. No onboarding carousels, no permission requests before the join screen. The first thing they see after sign-up is their friends' plan. Every extra screen is a drop-off risk.
Payment collection awkwardness: host-friend social tension if friend does not pay	Medium	The app handles the reminder, not the host. The host never has to message the friend directly. The UPI request is sent by District. This removes the social friction entirely while still getting the host their money.
Venue ticket inventory held inconsistently during group coordination	Medium	Inventory is not held during the planning and confirmation phase. It is only locked at the moment the host taps Book for the Group. This prevents tickets being held indefinitely by abandoned sessions.
Feature misuse: users create fake sessions just to get friends to install District	Low	A completed booking is required for the session to show the split payment flow. A session with no booking placed within 48 hours of the deadline expires automatically and generates no notification spam for friends.

09. Timeline

When	Milestone	Owner
Week 1	Stakeholder alignment and sign-off	PM
Week 2 to 3	Design: session creation flow, invite screen, confirmation screen, host booking summary, split payment tracker	Design
Week 2 to 3	Tech scoping: session state management, deep-link routing, invite link generation, UPI split payment API	Tech
Week 4	Prototype ready: host creation flow and friend join flow end-to-end	Design
Week 4 to 5	User testing: 8 sessions with real groups in Delhi NCR and Bengaluru	PM + Design
Week 3 to 8	Development: session engine, invite link, confirmation flow, group booking, split payment	Tech
Week 8 to 9	Internal pilot: District team tests with real venue bookings	PM + Tech
Week 10 to 12	Soft launch: Bengaluru and Delhi NCR, amusement and go-kart category only	PM + Growth
Week 14	Full rollout: all active District cities and all activity categories	PM + Growth
Week 18	30-day North Star review: group bookings per week, new installs via invite link, session abandonment rate	PM + Analytics

Critical path: the deep-link routing for non-District users is the highest risk in this feature. The install-and-land-in-session flow requires tight coordination between the marketing team (app store listing), growth team (deep-link setup), and engineering (session state persistence across install). If this is not ready for soft launch, the acquisition value of the feature drops significantly. A fallback where non-installed users see a read-only plan on browser is already scoped as the Phase 1 degraded state.

10. What Comes Next

This PRD covers Phase 1: host creates a plan, friends confirm attendance, host books for the group, split payment collection via UPI. The following features are planned based on 90-day learnings.

Phase	Feature	Why It Comes Next
2	Venue suggestions inside the session	Phase 1 requires the host to already know where they want to go. Phase 2 adds a 'Not sure yet' mode where the host proposes 2 to 3 venue options and friends vote on their preference. Moves Plan with Friends further up the discovery funnel.
2	Group booking history and re-plan	After a group completes a booking, District surfaces a 'Plan another outing with this group' CTA. Pre-fills the same friends, suggests new venues. Drives repeat group behavior without the host having to rebuild the session from scratch.
2	Direct split payment by each friend at checkout	Phase 1 uses host-pays-first for simplicity. Phase 2 explores simultaneous UPI collection at checkout so the host never fronts the full amount. Requires all friends to be responsive at booking time. A/B test against Phase 1 model to find conversion winner.
3	Plan with Friends for multi-venue day itinerary	Groups planning a full day out (amusement park in the afternoon, dinner after) can build a multi-venue plan. District handles both bookings in one session. Cross-vertical GMV opportunity.

Naveen Gupta | Aspiring Product Manager

This PRD was written from a genuine behavioral observation: group outings to amusement parks die in WhatsApp chats every week. Plan with Friends is built to fix that.